



26-SUPPORT-RUNBOOK-LIBRARY.md — One page per error code, written before the ticket arrives



Every error code in `11-ERROR-TAXONOMY.md` must have a runbook before the code is allowed to exist. A code without a runbook is a support ticket you have already decided to handle badly at 2 a.m.

1. The rule

CI fails if any code registered in `errors.toml` lacks `docs/runbooks/<code>.md`. This is a hard gate, not a documentation aspiration. The runbook is written by the engineer who introduced the code, at the moment they introduce it, while they still remember what causes it.

2. Runbook template

```
# AURA-RAW-2008 – RAW decode produced implausible dimensions

**Severity:** ItemFailed  **Recovery:** Quarantine  **Introduced:** v0.4.0

## What the user sees
"3 photos could not be read and were set aside. Everything else finished normally."
```

What actually happened

LibRaw returned a frame whose dimensions disagree with the EXIF header,
usually a truncated file or an unsupported compressed variant.

First three questions to ask

1. Which camera model? (most 2008 cases are one specific body)
2. Was the card ejected during copy, or copied over a network?
3. Does the file open in the camera manufacturer's own software?

Diagnosis

- Ask for the run bundle (Help > Export diagnostics). Open `errors.json`.
- Check `quarantine/` for the affected files' metadata sidecars.
- Reproduce: `cargo run -p aura-cli -- decode-probe <file>`

Resolution

Cause	Fix	Permanent?
Truncated file	Re-copy from card	User-side
Unsupported variant	Add camera to compatibility list; ship LibRaw bump	Needs release
Genuinely corrupt	Nothing recoverable; confirm quarantine behaved	N/A

Escalate when

More than 2 % of a single import hits this code, or the camera is already on the supported list.

Prevention

FMEA row F-11. Guard: dimension plausibility check at decode boundary.

3. Coverage by domain

Domain	Runbooks needed	Most common real-world ticket
IO 1000–1999	~18	External drive disconnected mid-import; long Windows paths; network volumes
RAW 2000–2999	~14	A camera body released after your last LibRaw bump
DB 3000–3999	~9	Catalog on Dropbox or OneDrive — the single most destructive user habit
GPU 4000–4999	~12	Driver timeout under load; laptop switching to integrated graphics on battery
ML 5000–5999	~11	Model pack download incomplete; EP unavailable after a driver update
CLOUD 6000–6999	~8	Spend cap reached; captive-portal hotel wifi returning HTML
JOB 7000–7999	~10	Machine slept mid-run; resumed run appears stuck
EXPORT 8000–8999	~9	Disk full at 3,800 of 4,000; destination folder permissions
SEC 9000–9999	~6	Consent not granted, user does not understand why cloud features are greyed out

4. The five tickets you will actually get most

Write these as full customer-facing help articles, not just internal runbooks:

1. **"It's slower than you promised."** Almost always thermal throttling on a laptop, an external drive over USB 2, or an integrated GPU. Ship a one-click Diagnose Performance report that names the bottleneck instead of arguing.
2. **"It picked the wrong photos."** Not a bug — a calibration mismatch. Route to style learning ([28-STYLE-LEARNING-SPEC.md](#)) and to the confidence threshold slider. Capture the disagreement as training signal if consent allows.

3. **"My catalog is corrupted."** Cloud-synced catalog folder, 90 % of the time. Detect it at project creation and refuse politely with an explanation, rather than fixing it after the fact.
4. **"The colours look different from Lightroom."** True, and expected — different rendering. Needs an honest comparison document, not a defensive one.
5. **"It crashed and I lost my work."** Verify resume actually worked; if it did not, this is a `JOB` domain bug and a P1, because R2 says every run is resumable.

5. Support tooling that pays for itself

- **Help > Export diagnostics** produces the run bundle from `19-OBSERVABILITY-AND-FORENSICS.md`, already redacted, as a single zip the user can attach. One click, no instructions needed.
- **A code lookup page:** `aura.app/e/AURA-RAW-2008` renders the user-facing half of the runbook. Put the URL in the error dialog itself.
- **Self-diagnose panel:** GPU and EP detected, disk speed, free space, thermal state, catalog location warning, model pack integrity. Most tickets resolve here without a human.
- **Severity SLAs:** Fatal 4 hours, RunBlocking 1 business day, ItemFailed 3 days, Degraded/Warning next release.

6. Acceptance criteria

- ☐ Every code in `errors.toml` has a runbook file; CI enforces it.
- ☐ Every runbook has all eight template sections filled with real content.
- ☐ The five common tickets exist as public help articles.
- ☐ Every error dialog in the UI links to its code lookup URL.
- ☐ Export diagnostics is reachable in one click and passes the redaction test.
- ☐ Ten runbooks have been walked by someone who did not write them, and their confusion recorded and fixed.

7. Claude Code prompt

Act as `DOC` (Documentation Lead) with `TLC` reviewing. Read `errors.toml` and generate `docs/runbooks/<code>.md` for every registered code using the section 2 template. Do not invent causes — for each code, trace the actual call sites that emit it and describe the real conditions, citing file:line.

Then add the CI gate that fails when a code has no runbook, and prove it by registering a dummy code without a runbook, showing the failure, and removing it. Finally, wire every error dialog to the code lookup URL, and list any code whose user-facing message does not state a next action.